Security Politics at the BRICS Forum and Russia–China Role

Present dimensions in world politics are entirely different from the nineteenth century's 'Concert of Nations' because the critical centers of world politics are not central. The United States and NATO, the EU, and Japan share military and political alliances. Russia and China are increasingly in conflict with them and have been moving closer to each other because of their circumstances. Brazil and India, on the other hand, have been gravitating toward them. Domestic factors, economic interdependence, and commonly shared vulnerabilities to new rising security threats are much more critical to relations between states and unions (Arbatov 2013). The Chinese President Hu Jintao visited the Russian Federation on June 26, 2011, to attend the tenth anniversary of the signing of the treaty of 'Good Neighborliness, Friendship, and Cooperation, Between China and Russia,' where Jintao remarked that this treaty had laid a solid foundation for the development of Russia–China bilateral and multilateral relations. Both the countries have increased their strategic cooperation sincerely since then. They have taken the same steps on a galaxy of regional and international issues, including promoting the SCO and BRICS group. The Russia–China partnership jointly advocated for the multi-polarization of international relations, global peace, and stability. Thus, this treaty has paved the way for a new security concept that features mutual trust, mutual benefit, equality, and coordination between these two countries (Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the People's Republic of China 2011a).

On March 17, 2011, when voting on Resolution 1973 (which paved the way for NATO to bomb Libya), Brazil, India, Russia, and China abstained from giving their consent, while South Africa supported it (Deich 2013). Does that mean South Africa officially managed to keep it (positive neutrality)? BRICS' official papers confirm that the resolution of its members works jointly on security issues. Furthermore, Russia and China were made to abstain from the UN Security Council Resolution of 1970, which permits armed interference in the Libyan conflict, and later Brazil joined in (Deich 2013). On the Syrian issue, too, BRICS had taken a different step, but all countries more or less took the same effort. The